UX CASE STUDY · AI HIRING PLATFORM

# Techies4Tech.ai

Designing an end-to-end hiring platform where AI interviews, evaluates and matches tech talent — so employers review evidence, not résumés.

AI Interviews | Automated Evaluation | Automated Hiring | Web + Mobile | Design System




| My role | Platforms | User roles designed | Timeline |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| Lead UX/UI Designer | Responsive web · Mobile | 7 personas | [ months ] |

01 · OVERVIEW

# One platform, two marketplaces, seven roles

Techies4Tech.ai finds, assesses and places AI-ready tech talent. Candidates are interviewed by AI before an employer ever sees them; employers receive a scored, per-skill shortlist. I redesigned the existing application end to end — from research to developer handoff — for every role that touches a hire.

C

### For candidates

Upload a résumé, let AI build the profile, take a recorded AI interview and coding work sample, then get matched to the role that fits best.

E

### For employers

Post a role or email a job description, choose **Job Listing** or **Hire Assured**, and review candidates who arrive already scored skill by skill.

O

### For the operations team

Account managers, recruiters, certified interviewers and admins review jobs, run manual interviews, manage clients and oversee contractors.

WHAT I DID

Existing app audit · Stakeholder interviews · Candidate & employer research · Competitive analysis · Personas · Journey maps · Information architecture · User flows · Design system · Web & mobile UI · Prototyping · Usability testing · Dev handoff

SCOPE AT A GLANCE

**7** user roles

**2** breakpoints · 1440 & 375

**1,300+** frames & states in Figma

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Figma prototyping, Dev Mode

02 · THE PROBLEM

# A résumé is a claim. Hiring teams had no fast way to check it.

Companies are spending heavily on AI but can't find people who can actually deliver with it. Tech hiring still runs on keyword-matched résumés, long manual screening and interview loops that burn engineers' time — while good candidates get no feedback and drop out.

**95%**

of enterprise generative-AI pilots show no measurable P&L impact — the gap is people and deployment, not the model.

MIT NANDA, State of AI in Business 2025

**~3×**

year-over-year growth in enterprise generative-AI spend in 2025. The budget exists; the talent to use it doesn't.

Menlo Ventures, Dec 2025

**$4B**

spent on AI for coding in 2025 — the largest category of enterprise AI spend, powered by engineers who build with AI.

Menlo Ventures, Dec 2025

**Problem statement**

How might we let employers hire tech talent on **proven skill** — not self-reported résumés — while giving candidates a fair, fast and transparent way to show what they can do?

# Double Diamond, run per role

With seven roles sharing one data model, I followed the Double Diamond but looped the Develop and Deliver phases per role, starting with the two that create the marketplace — candidate and employer.

DISCOVER

## Understand

- Audit of existing application & old website
- Stakeholder interviews
- Candidate interviews
- Employer interviews
- Competitive analysis

DEFINE

## Frame

- Affinity mapping of insights
- Personas for all 7 roles
- Current vs future journey maps
- Role-based IA & sitemap
- Problem statements & HMWs

DEVELOP

## Design

- User flows & wireframes
- Design system: styles & components
- High-fidelity UI — web 1440
- Responsive mobile UI — 375
- Interactive prototype

DELIVER

## Validate & ship

- Moderated usability testing
- Iteration on findings
- Annotated specs & states
- Developer handoff in Dev Mode
- Design QA on build



04 · DISCOVER — EXISTING APPLICATION AUDIT

# What the old product was getting wrong

I walked every flow of the existing application and website as each role, scoring issues against Nielsen's heuristics and tagging where users dropped off or needed help from the team.

Onboarding

### Long manual sign-up

Candidates re-typed everything already on their résumé. Skills, experience and role preferences were one long form with no sense of progress.

Assessment

### Interviews felt like a black box

No preparation, no explanation of what was recorded or why, and no status after submitting — the moment of highest anxiety had the least guidance.

Employer

### Résumé piles, not evidence

Employers saw applicant lists without scores or skill breakdowns and still had to screen manually, which defeated the point of AI assessment.

Plans

### Unclear hiring models

Job Listing vs Hire Assured wasn't explained in-product; employers couldn't tell who sources candidates or when they pay.

Operations

### Ops work lived outside the app

Job review, client assignment, manual interviews and contractor invoicing were handled over email and spreadsheets.

Consistency

### No shared system

Inconsistent buttons, inputs and states across screens, and layouts that didn't adapt to mobile — where many candidates first arrive.

05 · DISCOVER — USER RESEARCH

# Listening to both sides of the hire

I ran semi-structured interviews with candidates and hiring stakeholders, plus a competitive review of job boards, AI-interview tools and talent marketplaces. Notes were synthesised in FigJam through affinity mapping.

**[n]**
**Candidate interviews**
developers, data & ERP/CRM specialists, designers

**[n]**
**Employer interviews**
hiring managers, HR & talent leads

**[n]**
**Stakeholder sessions**
founders, account managers, interviewers

**5**
**Product categories reviewed**
job boards, AI interview, coding tests, talent networks, ATS

## What candidates told us

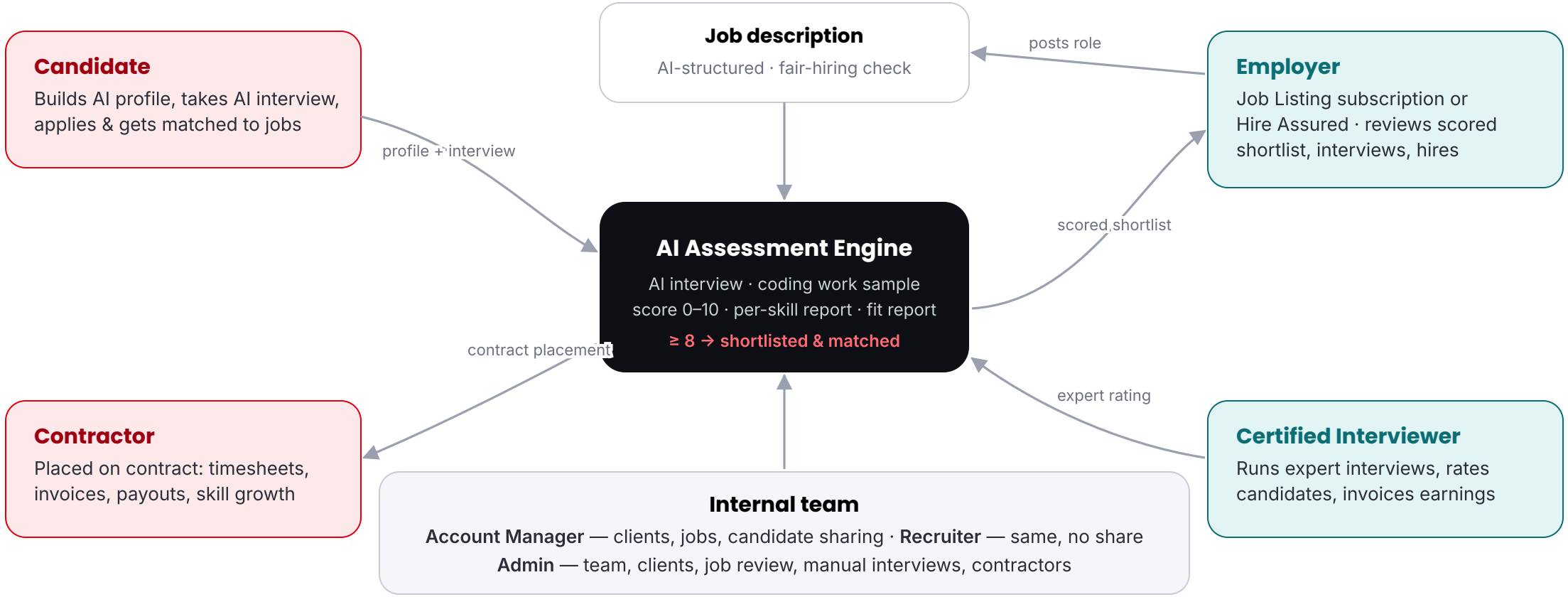
- Forms that repeat the résumé feel like busywork and cause drop-off.
- AI interviews are only acceptable if they know what's recorded, who sees it and how it's scored.
- They want to prove skill once and reuse it across many roles.
- Silence after applying is the most frustrating part of job hunting.
- Many first open the product on a phone.

## What employers told us

- Screening is the slowest part of hiring and eats engineers' time.
- Self-rated skills on résumés can't be trusted for niche roles (SAP, Salesforce, agentic AI).
- They want a short list with reasons, not a long list to sort.
- Some want a partner to source; others want to keep their own ATS.
- Pay-on-success models reduce the risk of trying a new vendor.

# Seven roles, one hiring pipeline

Research showed the product wasn't two-sided — it was a network. Mapping who hands work to whom shaped the IA and the permission model for every screen.



# The two people the marketplace is built for

Candidate

## JM Jason Macdonald

UI/UX & Product Designer · 5 yrs · open to full-time or contract

> *"I've done the work. I just need a way to prove it once — not on every application."*

### GOALS

- Land a role that matches his real skill level
- Spend less time on repetitive applications
- Get feedback, not silence

### FRUSTRATIONS

- Re-entering his résumé on every portal
- Opaque AI screening and video recording
- Being filtered out by keywords

### NEEDS FROM TECHIES4TECH

Résumé-to-profile in minutes · Clear interview prep & consent · Visible scores · AI-matched jobs · Works on mobile

Employer

## SR Sarah Reynolds

Director of Engineering · mid-size SaaS · hiring 6 roles this quarter

> *"Don't send me fifty résumés. Send me five people who can actually do it — and show me why."*

### GOALS

- Shorten time-to-hire for AI and niche roles
- Protect her engineers' interview hours
- Hire with less risk

### FRUSTRATIONS

- Unverifiable self-rated skills
- Agencies that forward volume, not fit
- Paying before seeing results

### NEEDS FROM TECHIES4TECH

Per-skill evidence · Short, ranked shortlist · Clear plan choice · Keep her ATS · Pay after hire

# The roles that keep the pipeline moving

Each supporting role got its own lightweight persona, workspace and permissions — designed as dedicated pages in the Figma file rather than afterthought admin screens.

Contractor

### Arjun, Cloud Engineer

> *"Log my hours, raise my invoice, get paid."*

NEEDS

- Timesheets
- Invoices & payouts
- Skill development

Certified Interviewer

### Meera, Senior SAP Architect

> *"Give me the context, then let me rate."*

NEEDS

- Interview opportunities
- Candidate context & rating
- Earning reports, invoices

Account Manager

### Daniel, Client Partner

> *"Which client needs a shortlist today?"*

NEEDS

- My clients & their jobs
- Candidate search & share
- Manual interviews

Recruiter

### Aisha, Tech Recruiter

> *"Find and vet — the AM decides what goes out."*

NEEDS

- Same tools as AM
- Share to client disabled
- Feedback on applicants

Admin

### Robert, Ops Head

> *"Nothing goes live without a check."*

NEEDS

- Team & client management
- Jobs under review
- Contractor oversight

**Design implication**

One shared component library and data model, with **role-based navigation and permissions**. Example: the Recruiter reuses the Account Manager flow end-to-end, but the *Share* action in the applicant list is disabled — one design, two permission states.

# Jason's journey: from résumé to matched role

| | 1 · Discover | 2 · Sign up | 3 · Build profile | 4 · AI interview | 5 · Results | 6 · Matched & hired |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Doing | Finds a role or gets a job ID from a recruiter | Uploads résumé, verifies email & phone OTP, gives consent | Rates skills, sets role & employment preferences, adds photo | Records intro, answers AI questions, does coding sample | Views per-skill assessment & score | Gets AI-recommended jobs, applies, interviews |
| Thinking | “Is this another job board?” | “Please don't make me retype my CV.” | “How long is this going to take?” | “Who sees this video? How am I scored?” | “Did I pass? What do I improve?” | “These jobs actually fit me.” |
| Emotion |  | | | | | |
| Design response | Clear candidate vs employer entry; “Have a job ID?” shortcut | Résumé-first sign-up; AI pre-fills the account | 3-step checklist with % complete; review before submit | Plain-language recording consent, timer & question count | View-assessment report by skill | AI Recommended Jobs + AI resume builder |

# Sarah's journey: from job description to hire

| | 1 · Sign up | 2 · Choose plan | 3 · Post role | 4 · Candidates assessed | 5 · Review evidence | 6 · Interview & hire |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Doing | Registers as employer, sets up company profile | Compares Job Listing subscription with Hire Assured | Posts a job or emails the JD; it's checked and reviewed | Waits while applicants take AI interviews | Opens applicants, skill reports and recordings | Gives feedback, schedules interviews, hires |
| Thinking | “How fast can I get going?” | “Who sources? When do I pay?” | “Is my JD good enough?” | “Is anything happening?” | “Can I trust these scores?” | “That was much faster.” |
| Emotion |  | | | | | |
| Design response | Shared sign-up shell, “Get started” guide | Side-by-side plans; separate flows & nav per plan | Review & success states; AM notified by email | Notifications & dashboard pipeline counts | Candidate profile, skills tab, view assessment | Feedback & rating, job interview modal |

# Role-based navigation from one shared shell

Every role shares sign-in, settings and the side-navigation pattern; the modules inside it change with the role and, for employers, with the plan they bought.

### Candidate

- Sign in / sign up
- Basic steps
- My profile
- Jobs
- AI recommended jobs
- AI interview
- Build AI résumé
- Dashboard
- Settings

### Employer

- Sign in / sign up
- Basic steps
- Job listing or Hire Assured
- Manage jobs
- Applicants & candidate profile
- Manage subscription
- Company profile
- User management
- Dashboard · Settings

### Certified Interviewer

- Sign in / sign up
- Basic steps
- My profile
- Opportunities
- Candidate interviews
- Earning reports
- Invoice
- Dashboard

### Account Mgr / Recruiter

- Job list
- My clients
- Candidate management
- Candidate search
- Manual interview
- Email templates
- Dashboard

### Admin

- Team management
- Client management
- Candidate management
- Jobs under review
- Manual interview
- Contractors
- Job search

### Contractor

- Sign up
- Dashboard
- Timesheet
- Create timesheet
- Invoice & creation
- Payout
- Skill development

# The heart of the product: prove it once

The AI interview is where trust is won or lost. I designed it as a guided, transparent sequence — every step tells the candidate what happens next, what is recorded and how it counts.

STEP 1
**Consent**
Plain-language recording consent: what's recorded, why, who sees it, PIPEDA & CCPA.

STEP 2
**Intro video**
Short self-introduction with camera & mic check before anything is scored.

STEP 3
**AI interview**
AI asks questions on the role's must-have skills; timer and progress always visible.

STEP 4
**Coding sample**
For hands-on roles: pick a language, build with an AI assistant — every exchange is recorded.

STEP 5
**Automatic scoring**
Scored 0–10 per skill; the work sample is re-scored, including how well AI was directed.

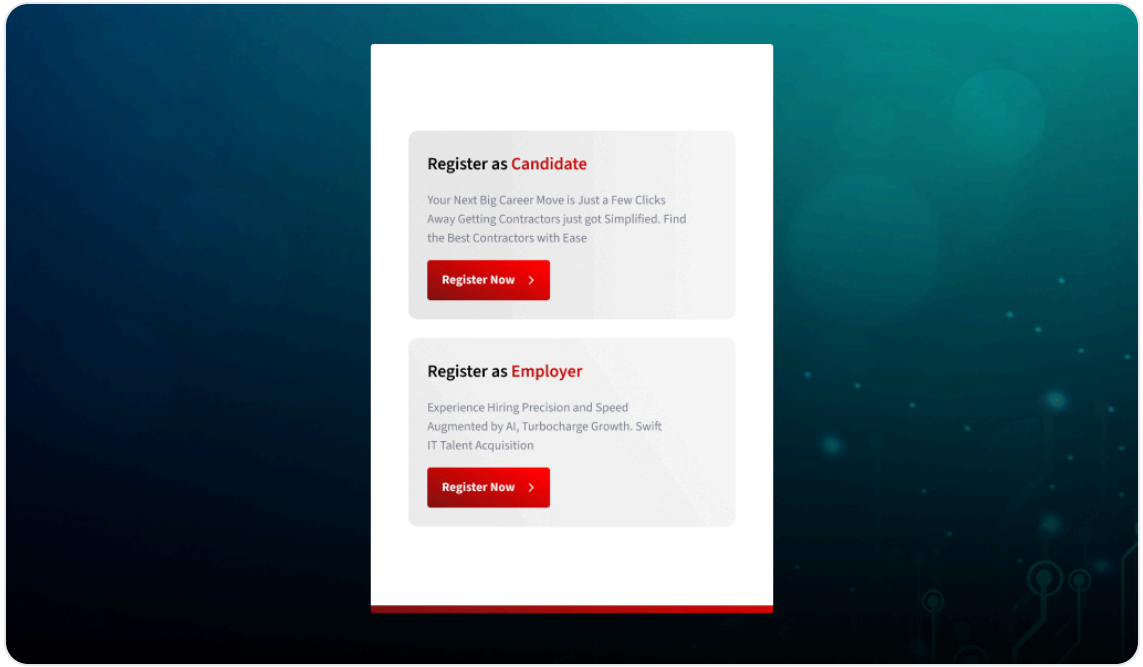
STEP 6
**Auto-shortlist**
8 or above is routed to the best-fit role; employers get the top few, already scored.

CLAIMED
**What the candidate says**
Self-rated skill from Basic Steps. Guides what to assess — never moves anyone up a shortlist on its own.

EVIDENCED
**What the history shows**
Read from the résumé by AI: projects, scope and years behind each skill. Not editable by hand.

VALIDATED
**What they proved**
Set only by assessments; best attempt kept. Shown separately so employers see all three readings, never blended.

# Decisions that came straight from research




Sign-up entry: candidates and employers choose their path on one screen, then each gets a tailored flow.

### 1 · Résumé-first sign-up

Candidates upload a résumé (doc, docx, pdf) and AI pre-fills the account, so the first screen saves effort instead of asking for it.

### 2 · Progress you can see

Basic Steps breaks setup into Rate your expertise → Employment & role → Professional photo, with a live "% completed" bar and a review screen.

### 3 · Skills rated in context

Each skill row pairs an on/off toggle, years of experience and a Beginner–Advanced slider, grouped by category — fast to scan, honest to fill.

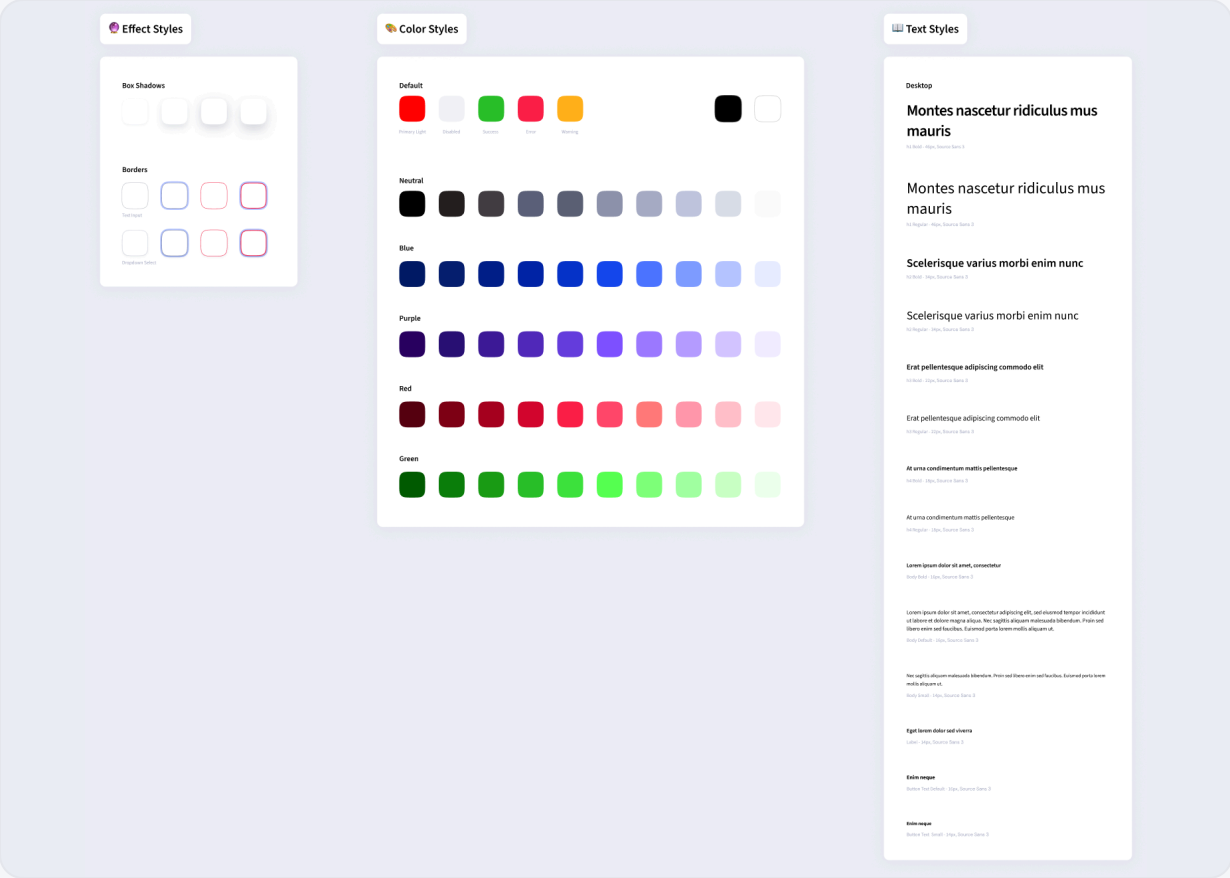
### 4 · Consent before camera

Communication consent at sign-up and recording consent before interviews, written in plain language with a clear "Do not agree" option.

### 5 · Plan-aware employer UI

Job Listing and Hire Assured get separate sign-up paths and side-navs, so employers only see what their plan includes.

# A system built for seven products in one




Styles page from the Figma file: effect styles, color ramps and the desktop type scale.

## Color

Brand red for primary actions; semantic Success, Error, Warning and Disabled; 10-step Neutral, Blue, Purple, Red and Green ramps.

## Typography — Source Sans 3

H1 46 · H2 34 · H3 22 · H4 18 (bold & regular), Body 16 / 14, Label 14, Button 16 / 14 — one family for dense dashboards and long consent copy.

## Components

Button · Text input · Dropdown · Phone input · OTP field · File upload · Tabs · Radio · Skill slider · Progress bar · Modal · Message banner · Side nav · Tables

## States built in

Inputs ship with default, focus, error (“Something went wrong”) and helper-text states, plus optional / required labels — so developers never invent a state.

# Web and mobile, designed side by side

Every candidate flow was designed at 1440 for web and 375 for mobile. Mobile wasn't a shrink-down: long forms became stacked sections and the interview became a full-screen, one-question-at-a-time recorder.

**Candidate · web**

- Sign in, sign up, email & phone OTP
- Basic steps, review profile, benefit screen
- My profile, skills & view assessment
- Jobs — search, filters, table view
- AI recommended jobs
- AI interview & coding interview
- AI-assisted résumé with preview
- Dashboard & settings

**Candidate · mobile**

- Upload résumé & verification
- Quick sight → Skills → Work history
- Education → Certificates → Photo
- Jobs with filter sheet
- Calendar & “no schedule” states
- Start recording, timer, question
- Programming language picker
- Assessment result & dashboard

**Certified Interviewer**

- Same onboarding pattern as candidates
- Opportunities to interview
- Candidate interviews & search
- Rating screen after each interview
- Earning reports
- Invoice creation → generated invoice
- Dashboard
- Mobile versions of core flows

# Two hiring models, two tailored experiences

Employers sign up once, then the product reshapes around the plan they choose — separate side-navs, dashboards and job panels for Job Listing and Hire Assured, on web and mobile.

Job Listing

### Subscribe, post, assess

Employers post jobs under a subscription; applicants take the role's assessments and appear with full reports. Includes manage subscription and “subscription required” states.

Hire Assured

### We source, you choose

Techies4Tech recommends pre-assessed candidates. The fee is due only after a successful full-time hire, with a 90-day replacement guarantee.

### Shared employer screens

- Get started
- Manage jobs
- Post a job
- Review message
- Applicants
- Candidate profile
- Candidate skills
- View assessment
- Feedback & rating
- Company profile
- User management
- Notifications
- Dashboard

# Operations moved out of email and into the product

Work that used to happen over email and spreadsheets got its own screens, built from the same component library as the customer-facing product.

**Account Manager + Recruiter**

- My clients & job list
- Candidate management & search
- Share profile to client (disabled for Recruiter)
- Manual interview
- Email templates

**Admin**

- Team management
- Client management, assignment & subscription history
- Jobs under review — one queue before anything goes live
- Manual interview
- Contractors & job search

**Contractor**

- Dashboard
- Timesheet & create timesheet
- Invoice creation → generated invoice
- Payout tracking
- Skill development

# Prototyping the moments that matter most

I built clickable Figma prototypes for the riskiest flows first — where a confusing step would cost a hire or a candidate's trust — on both 1440 web and 375 mobile frames.

1

### Candidate onboarding

Role selection → résumé upload → processing → email & phone OTP → personal details → basic steps → review profile → benefit screen.

2

### AI interview

Job interview invite → recording consent → calendar/no schedule → start recording → questions with timer → coding language → assessment result.

3

### Employer hiring

Sign up → choose plan → post a job → review message → applicants → candidate profile & skills → view assessment → feedback.

4

### Account manager

Notification → job review → candidate search → share profile to client (disabled for Recruiter) → manual interview.

5

### Certified interviewer

Opportunities → candidate interview → rating → earning report → invoice creation → generated invoice.

6

### Contractor

Dashboard → create timesheet → invoice creation → generated invoice → payout.

# Testing with real candidates and hiring managers

Moderated, task-based sessions on the prototype — think-aloud, followed by a short SUS questionnaire. Each finding was logged by severity and fixed before handoff.

**[n]**
participants (candidates + employers)

**[n]**
core tasks tested

**[%]**
task success rate

**[score]**
SUS score

| WHAT WE OBSERVED | ITERATION | SEVERITY |
|---|---|---|
| Candidates hesitated before starting the recording — unsure who would see it. | Added a dedicated recording-consent step listing each video (intro, AI interview, coding) and who can access it. | High |
| Users didn't know how much onboarding was left. | Introduced the 3-card Basic Steps checklist with a “% completed” progress bar. | High |
| Employers confused Job Listing and Hire Assured. | Split into two plan-specific flows and side-navs, with a clear subscription screen. | Medium |
| OTP entry failed when codes expired silently. | Added a visible 02:00 countdown with “Resend OTP” and inline error states. | Medium |
| Skill ratings were inflated and slow on mobile. | Added an “only skills used in the last 2 years” hint and stacked the slider rows for 375 screens. | Low |

# A file developers could build from, not guess from

### Organised by role and flow

Pages for Cover, Styles, Components, Landing pages, and one page per role — each split into labelled sections (Sign in/Sign up, Basic steps, Profile, Jobs, AI Interview…) in user-flow order.

### Every state designed

Empty, loading (“Processing”), success, error, review and disabled states; modals, banners and tooltips placed next to the screens that trigger them.

### Two breakpoints, one component set

Desktop at 1440 and mobile at 375 built from the same components, so the responsive behaviour is explicit.

### Specs & annotations

Dev Mode for measurements, tokens and assets; written notes for rules that can't be drawn — e.g. Recruiter follows the AM flow with Share disabled.

### Content & compliance ready

Final consent and legal copy (communications, terms, recording consent referencing PIPEDA & CCPA) delivered in the designs, not as placeholders.

### Design QA loop

Reviewed builds against Figma, logged visual and interaction bugs, and updated components when engineering constraints changed a pattern.

21 · OUTCOMES & LEARNINGS

# From résumé piles to scored shortlists

**7**
roles designed on one shared system

**2**
hiring models supported end to end

[ ]
reduction in onboarding time

[ ]
profile / interview completion

### Trust is a UX problem

AI only works in hiring if people understand it. Consent, transparency and separating claimed, evidenced and validated skill did more for adoption than any visual polish.

### Design the network, not the screens

Mapping all seven roles early exposed handoffs between people — the source of most real delays — and turned them into features.

### Systems scale teams

A shared component library let one design team cover web and mobile for every role, and gave developers fewer decisions to make.

Next

Measure post-launch funnels per role · test the coding work-sample with AI assistant at scale · expand mobile for employers

**Thank you.**